



Broken Bones: First Aid

If you think a bone may be broken, stay calm and follow these steps:



1 Control any bleeding

Cover the wound with a clean cloth or sterile bandage, then apply gentle pressure unless the bone is protruding.



2 Immobilize the area

Stabilize the limb with padding and splint if trained. DO NOT attempt to realign bone.



3 Apply ice to the injury

Fill a bag with ice, wrap it in a clean cloth or towel, and apply to swollen or red area.



4 Treat for shock

If the person is faint or hyperventilating, lay them down, raise their legs, and cover them in a blanket.



5 Seek medical care

Go to an urgent care or orthopedic specialist to get the bone reset and receive further treatment.



Call 911 Immediately if...



- Bone is protruding from the skin
- Break resulted from significant trauma (e.g. car crash or high fall)
- Injury involves the neck, head, or back
- Person is unresponsive or unconscious
- There is heavy bleeding or numbness in the extremities (e.g. fingers or toes)



Signs of a Broken Bone

- Persistent swelling, warmth, redness, or bruising
- Severe pain, especially when moving or applying pressure to the area
- A visible deformity
- Difficulty supporting weight or moving the affected limb
- Numbness or tingling near the injury



Prevention

Build strong bones, practice safe movement, and prevent painful breaks.



1 Stay active

Activities like running and weightlifting build denser bone tissue, while other exercises improve balance and decrease falls.



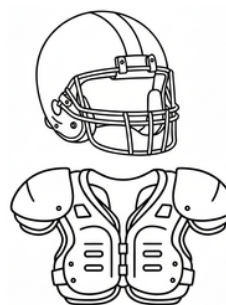
2 Clear walkways

Keep floors and walkways clear. Most fractures happen because of falls, so learn how to land safely if you do trip.



3 Eat healthy foods

Choose foods rich in calcium and vitamin D, and ask your doctor if supplements could help.



4 Gear up for sports

Wear helmets and padding to protect yourself during contact or high-speed sports.



5 Wear your seatbelt

Always wear a seatbelt in the car. Children under 8 should ride in a car seat.

References

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